Last Updated: *May 2024*

TikTok Fact-Checking Training

TikTok

This information is confidential as part of our partnership

TikTok's Approach to Misinformation

https://www.tiktok.com/community-guidelines/en/integrity-authenticity

Misinformation

In a global community, it is natural for people to have different opinions, but we seek to operate on a shared set of facts and reality. **We do not allow misinformation that may cause significant harm to individuals or society, regardless of intent.** We rely on independent fact-checking partners, guidance from public health authorities, and our database of previously fact-checked claims to help assess the accuracy of content.

Content is ineligible for the FYF if it contains misinformation that may cause moderate harm, such as certain health content, conspiracy theories, repurposed media, or misrepresented authoritative sources. To be cautious, unverified information about emergencies and content temporarily under review by fact-checkers is also ineligible for the FYF.

To help you manage your TikTok experience, we may apply warning labels to content that has been assessed by our fact-checking partners and cannot be verified as accurate. We may also send prompts to reconsider sharing such content.

TikTok's Approach to Misinformation

More information

Misinformation means false or misleading content.

Significant harm means severe forms of physical harm (including life-threatening injury or death), psychological harm (including trauma), large-scale property damage, and societal harm (including undermining fundamental social processes or institutions).

Moderate harm health misinformation means false or misleading content regarding the treatment or prevention of injuries, conditions, or illnesses that are not immediate or life-threatening.

Conspiracy theories means beliefs about unexplained events, or involve rejecting generally accepted explanations for events, including suggesting they were carried out by covert or powerful individuals or groups.

Repurposed media means unedited media content that is presented out of context and may mislead a person about a developing topic of public importance.

Misrepresented authoritative sources means content that promotes misleading correlations or conclusions related to authoritative information that is recognized and trusted, such as reports from research institutions.

NOT ALLOWED

- Misinformation that poses a risk to public safety or may induce panic about a crisis event or emergency, including using historical footage of a previous attack as if it were current, or incorrectly claiming a basic necessity (such as food or water) is no longer available in a particular location
- Health misinformation, such as misleading statements about vaccines, inaccurate medical advice that discourages people from getting appropriate medical care for a life-threatening disease, or other misinformation which may cause negative health effects on an individual's life
- Climate change misinformation that undermines well-established scientific consensus, such as denying the existence of climate change or the factors that contribute to it
- Conspiracy theories that name and attack individual people
- Conspiracy theories that are violent or hateful, such as making a violent call to action, having links to previous violence, denying well-documented violent events, or causing prejudice towards a group with a protected attribute

FYF INELIGIBLE

- Conspiracy theories that are unfounded and claim that certain events or situations are carried out by covert or powerful groups, such as "the government" or a "secret society"
- Moderate harm health misinformation, such as an unproven recommendation for how to treat a minor illness
- Repurposed media, such as showing a crowd at a music concert and suggesting it is a political protest
- Misrepresenting authoritative sources, such as selectively referencing certain scientific data to support a conclusion that is counter to the findings of the study
- Unverified claims related to an emergency or unfolding event
- Potential high-harm misinformation while it is undergoing a fact-checking review

ALLOWED

- Statements of personal opinion (as long as it does not include harmful misinformation)
- People sharing their own stories or experiences about medical treatment or procedures, or health care systems (as long as it does not contain harmful misinformation, or encourage people to ignore professional medical advice or public health

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TikTok's Approach to Misinformation

Civic and Election Integrity

Elections are important events and are often the subject of intense discussion and analysis. We try to balance enabling these discussions, while also being a place that brings people together and does not cause division. **We do not allow paid political promotion, political advertising, or fundraising by politicians and political parties (for themselves or others).** Our political advertising policy includes both traditional paid advertisements and creators receiving compensation to support or oppose a candidate for office.

We want to enable the informed exchange of civic ideas in a way that fosters productive dialogue. **We do not allow misinformation or content about civic and electoral processes that may result in voter interference, disrupt the peaceful transfer of power, or lead to off-platform violence.**

Content may be ineligible for the FYF if it contains misinformation that can hinder the ability of a voter to make an informed decision. To be cautious, unverified claims about an election and content temporarily under review by fact-checkers may also be ineligible for the FYF.

To help you manage your TikTok experience, we may apply warning labels to content that has been assessed by our fact-checking partners and cannot be verified as accurate. Learn more about our election integrity work, and Government, Politician and Political Party accounts.

More information

Misinformation means false or misleading content.

NOT ALLOWED

- Election misinformation, including:
  - How, when, and where to vote or register to vote
  - Eligibility requirements of voters to participate in an election, and the qualifications for candidates to run for office
  - Laws, processes, and procedures that govern the organization and implementation of elections and other civic processes, such as referendums, ballot propositions, or censuses
  - Final results or outcome of an election
- Promoting or providing instruction on illegal participation and electoral interference, including intimidation of voters, election workers, and electoral observers
- Calling for the disruption of a legitimate outcome of an election outside of the legal system, such as through a coup

FYF INELIGIBLE

- Unverified claims about an election, such as a premature claim that all ballots have been counted or tallied
- Statements that significantly misrepresent authoritative civic information, such as a false claim about the text of a parliamentary bill

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TikTok Transparency Center

https://www.tiktok.com/transparency/en-us/combating-misinformation/

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- Our commitments
  - Keeping people safe
  - Maintaining platform integrity
    - Supporting responsible, transparent AI-generated content
    - Protecting the integrity of elections
    - Combating harmful misinformation
    - Countering influence operations
    - Labelling state-affiliated media entities
    - Strengthening security and privacy
  - Building responsibly
  - Supporting independent research and content transparency
  - Upholding human rights
- Reports

Partnering with experts

TikTok partners with experts across the world to support consistent and accurate moderation, understand local context, and empower our community with authoritative information.

TikTok's Global Fact-checking Program

When potential misinformation is detected, our Integrity and Authenticity moderators must determine whether it's accurate, false, or unverifiable in order to apply our policies. To do so, they consult a global database of previously fact-checked claims and then route any new, evolving, or borderline claims to our Global Fact-Checking Program for independent evaluation.

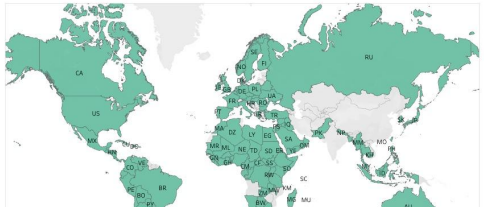
Through our Global Fact-Checking Program, we partner closely with 18 IFCN-accredited fact-checking organizations who assess the accuracy of content on TikTok in over 50 languages and 100 countries across the world. These partners do not moderate content directly on TikTok, but assess whether a claim is true, false, or unsubstantiated so that our moderators can take the right action based on our Community Guidelines. They also share intelligence that helps us detect harmful misinformation and anticipate misinformation trends.

Here's how our Global Fact-Checking Program works:

1. We detect potential harmful misinformation. In order to apply our Community Guidelines, we must confirm that it is indeed misinformation.
2. To do so, moderators consult our database of previously fact-checked claims. If the content in question represents a new or evolving claim, they route it to our fact-checking partners for assessment.
   - While the content is being fact-checked, we may make it ineligible for the For You feed out of an abundance of caution.
3. Once fact-checkers have assessed the content, our moderators apply our Community Guidelines accordingly.
   - **If content is determined to be accurate**, it stays on the platform and is eligible for For You feeds (as long as it doesn't violate any other Community Guidelines).
   - **If content is confirmed as harmful misinformation that violates our Community Guidelines**, our moderators apply our policies and either remove the video or restrict its reach.
   - If **content can't be verified after fact-checking,** we may label it as unverified and make it ineligible for For You feeds to reduce its reach.

When choosing our fact-checking partners, we prioritize organizations that are IFCN-certified, employ locally-based journalists, and specialize in assessing misinformation on social media and in short-form videos. Many of our fact-checking partners cover several countries, which helps us scale the program to support global moderation. We currently work with: Agence France-Presse (AFP), Animal Politico, Australian Associated Press (AAP), Code for Africa, dpa Deutsche Presse-Agentur, Demagog, Estadão Verifica, Facta, Lead Stories, Logically Facts, Newschecker, Newtral, Poligrafo, PolitiFact, Reuters, Science Feedback, and Teyit.

Global Fact-Checking coverage:



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Background

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How it works

Fact Checkers

1. Research claim

2. Assign rating & write reporting notes

3. Submit to TikTok

Moderators

1. Review the rating + reporting

2. Consider relevant policies

3. Apply policy

Goal: Provide fact checkers with relevant and understandable rating options that enable TikTok to enforce our Community Guidelines consistently

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Updates

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What's Changing?

1. Rating Options & Definitions
2. Category Options (previously called sub-classifications) & Definitions
3. Categories will be single-select instead of multi-select
4. Removing Harm Classification
5. Removing Extra Claim Fields

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What's Not Changing?

1. Claim Type & Definitions

2. Open-Text Fields (Claim in Video/Notes/URL)

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Deep Dive: Old Ratings

Misinformation: Must be verifiably false or verifiably misleading
Unconfirmed/Disputed: Unverifiable information about a current and unfolding event where the facts are still developing and/or are not yet confirmed, but we expect that they will be confirmed eventually by authoritative sources
Not Misinformation: Information that is not verifiably false or verifiably misleading. It could mean that there is no reason to believe that the information is false or misleading, factually accurate, or represents humor, satire, or opinion
Nothing to Fact-Check: Content that either has no fact-checkable claim or is in a language that your staff does not review for TikTok

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Deep Dive: New Ratings

False
- Claims that are verifiably false and disproven by credible evidence
- Visuals, audio, or text which claim to portray an event that did not occur or depict a person saying/doing something they did not do/say

Misleading
- Claims that are missing necessary context and likely to result in an incorrect understanding
- Claims that are contradicted by, or give the wrong impression of, expert consensus

Unsubstantiated
- Claims that are not supported by evidence or make conclusions that are not substantiated

Inconclusive
- Claims that cannot be verified because there is conflicting/disputed evidence, differing accounts of events, or because it is part of a developing/ongoing event about which facts can not yet be confirmed

True
- Claims that are verifiably true and proven or substantiated by credible evidence
- Claims which are accurate based on expert consensus

Out of Scope
- Claims that do not make a statement of fact. This may include humor, satire, opinions, commentary, or hate speech
- Content in a language that your staff does not cover for TikTok

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Deep Dive: Old Categories (formerly Sub-Classifications)

General Classification:			
Misinformation (must be verifiably false)	**Unconfirmed/Disputed**	**Not Misinformation**	**Nothing to Fact-Check**
First drop-down category/topic:			
COVID-19 Vaccine	COVID-19 Vaccine	Factually accurate	No fact-checkable claim
Other Vaccine	Other Vaccine	Satire/humor	Not my language
COVID-19	COVID-19	Opinion	Other
Other Medical	Other Medical	Other	
Crisis	Crisis		
Election	Election		
Political	Political		
Edited Media	Edited Media		
Climate	Climate		
Dangerous Conspiracy Theories (a conspiracy theory that casts blame on a named, living individual or a protected group, or denies a violent tragedy, or includes a call to violent action. This includes conspiracy theories created or spread by QAnon.)	Dangerous Conspiracy Theories (a conspiracy theory that casts blame on a named, living individual or a protected group, or denies a violent tragedy, or includes a call to violent action. This includes conspiracy theories created or spread by QAnon.)		
Financial	Financial		
General Conspiracy Theory (a conspiracy theory that casts blame on a group of people OR an organization, government or nation state.)	General Conspiracy Theory (a conspiracy theory that casts blame on a group of people OR an organization, government or nation state.)		
Other	Other		

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Deep Dive: New Categories

False, Misleading, Unsubstantiated, Inconclusive
AIGC/Edited Media: AIGC is content created using AI tooling. Edited media is content that has been manipulated.
Civic/Elections: Claims on elections, other civic processes, or authoritative sources of civic information.
Climate: Claims outright denying the reality of climate change or disputing established scientific consensus that climate change is real or about its causes.
Conspiracy Theory: Claims that blame individuals, groups, or organizations for acting in secret for their benefit against common good. Claims that deny major violent events.
Consumer/Commercial: Claims on consumer or commercial products.
Crisis/Unrest: Claims that present danger of public panic, violence, or unrest. Crisis events include natural disasters, armed conflict, terrorist attacks, epidemics and safety emergencies.

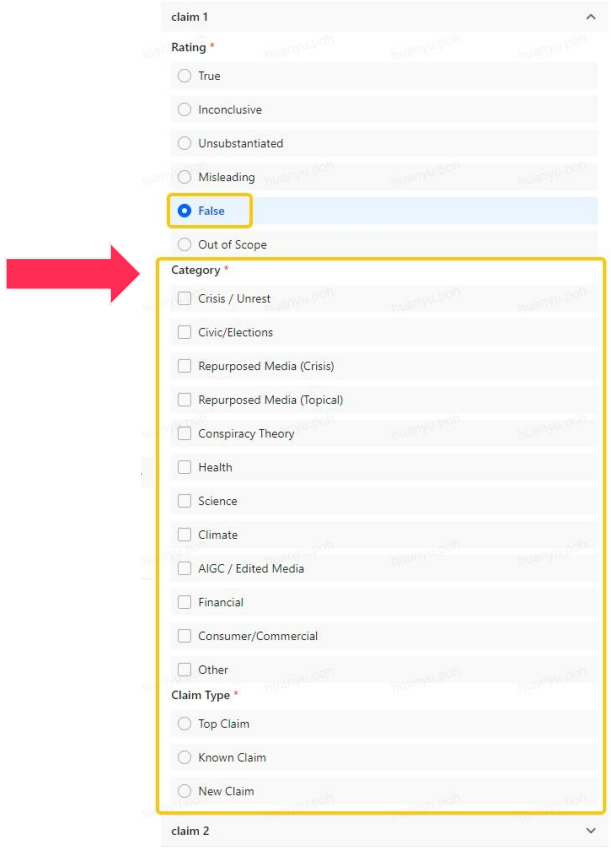
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Deep Dive: Categories

False, Misleading, Unsubstantiated, Inconclusive
Financial: Claims about financial issues, including financial institutions.
Health: Health advice that could lead to harm, including advice that could be life-threatening or lead to severe injury.
Other: Content does not fall into any of the categories above.
Repurposed Media (crisis): Video, imagery, or audio that has not been altered from the original but is used out of context and could mislead or confuse viewers in a crisis situation.
Repurposed Media (topical): Video, imagery, or audio that has not been altered from its original format but is used out of context and could mislead or confuse viewers outside of a crisis situation.
Science: Assertions or hypotheses about scientific phenomena or principles.

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Deep Dive: New Categories



**Sub-classifications, rebranded to "categories" and are single select*

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Deep Dive: Categories

True
No category needed

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Deep Dive: Categories

Out of Scope
Hate: The content is inherently hateful.
No Fact-Checkable Claim: Content that does not contain a fact-based claim including satire and opinion.
Not My Language: Content that is not in Fact Checker's language.

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Examples

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False

- **Video footage claiming to show the 2023 Syria earthquake but actually showing footage from the 2020 Beirut explosion**

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Misleading

- *"Ozempic is an easy way for anyone to lose weight!"*

  (15% of patients are unlikely to lose weight)

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Unsubstantiated

- *“While VP, Biden approved $1 billion in aid to Ukraine in exchange for firing the prosecutor investigating Biden's son."*

- *"Malaysian Airlines flight 370 was ‘made to disappear’ so one party could become the sole holder of a multi-party owned patent"*

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Inconclusive

- *"Hamas misfired the rocket that destroyed Al-Ahli hospital."*

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True

- *"Rishi Sunak is the UK's current Prime Minister."*

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Example 1

Explanation: Text on screen claims to show footage of Hamas paratroopers invading Israel. However, the footage is actually from a military exercise in Egpyt; it was shared online 2 weeks *before* Hamas's October 7th attack.

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Example 1

Explanation: Text on screen claims to show footage of Hamas paratroopers invading Israel. However, the footage is actually from a military exercise in Egpyt; it was shared online 2 weeks *before* Hamas's October 7th attack.

Rating: False

Category: Repurposed Media (Crisis)

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Example 2

Explanation: User responds to claims that Oxford is not implementing a climate lockdown by showing documents detailing the town's 15 minute city proposal. This user is conflating climate lockdowns and traffic deterrents with 15 minute cities.

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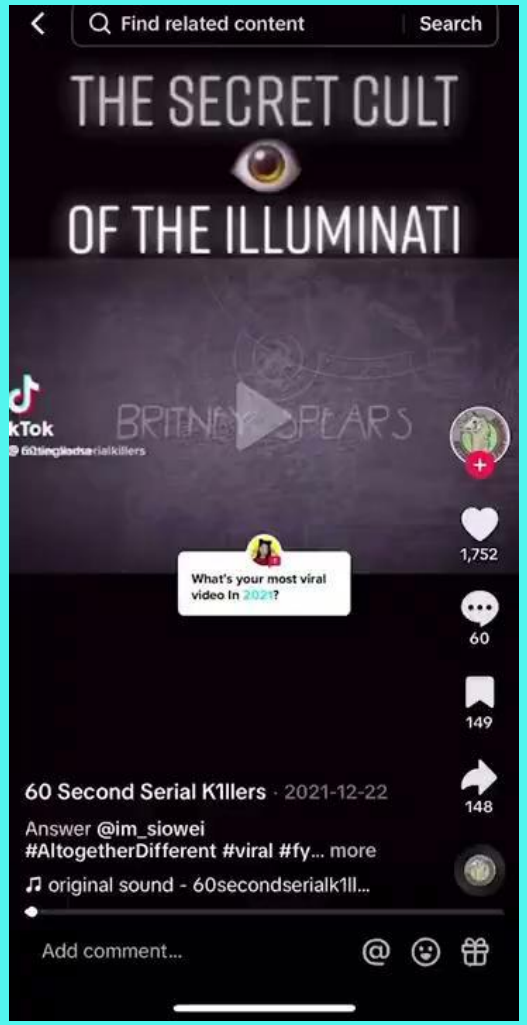
Example 2

Explanation: User responds to claims that Oxford is not implementing a climate lockdown by showing documents detailing the town's 15 minute city proposal. This user is misleadingly conflating climate lockdowns and traffic deterrents with 15 minute cities.

Rating: Misleading

Category: Conspiracy Theory

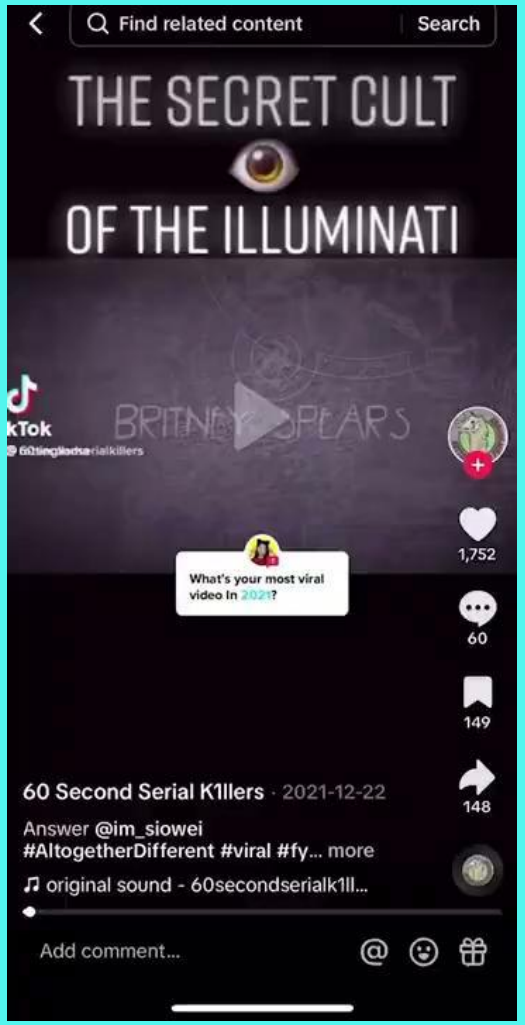
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Example 3

Explanation: Video alleges that the Illuminati controls Disney, which brainwashed Britney Spears and this explains her “breakdown”

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Example 3

Explanation: Video alleges that the Illuminati controls Disney, which brainwashed Britney Spears and this explains her "breakdown"

Rating: Unsubstantiated

Category: Conspiracy Theory

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FAQs

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Q1: How should I choose a single Category when multiple may be applicable?

A: Because videos have many elements and there are often multiple topics covered, we anticipate that there may be instances where multiple categories could be applicable.

We ask that you select the category which most closely matches the most egregiously false claim reviewed in the video. This may include the categories of: Crisis/Unrest, Civic/Elections, Conspiracy Theory, Repurposed Media (Crisis) & Health.

Our teams will also find it useful if you include in the Notes sections, which additional Categories you believe are applicable.

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Q2: How should we understand the differences between Inconclusive, Unsubstantiated, Misleading & False ratings? (Part 1)

A: It might help to think of these ratings in groups.

Unconfirmed/Disputed is now most closely related to the **Inconclusive** & **Unsubstantiated** ratings.

- **Inconclusive** → New information is likely to arise regarding the claim.
  - This will most likely be selected during developing/ongoing events, such as during military offensives or in the immediate aftermath of natural disasters.

- **Unsubstantiated** → No new information is likely to arise regarding the claim.
  - This will likely be selected in instances where there is no ongoing investigation or the truth is decidedly unknown. For example, many conspiracy theories will likely meet the threshold for "not supported by evidence or substantiated" due to their absurd nature.
  - Please note that claims rated unsubstantiated might have formerly been classified as either unconfirmed/disputed or misinformation

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Q2: How should we understand the differences between Inconclusive, Unsubstantiated, & Misleading ratings? (Part 2)

A: It might help to think of these ratings in groups.

Misinformation is now most closely related to **False** & **Misleading** ratings.

- **False** → Verifiably untrue claim as proven by trusted sources
- **Misleading** → Deceptive or confusing claim. This could be a claim that is confusing or missing important context such that the viewer is likely to form a false impression of the events/information.

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Q3: Should we use the Notes section to clarify why we've selected "no fact-checkable claim"?

A: Yes, when you select “No Fact-Checkable Claim,” please include a brief explanation in the Notes section why the claim/video is not able to be fact-checked.

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Q4: How should we apply the Health vs Science Categories?

A: The Health Category is intended to capture medical/individual well-being claims, whereas "Science" is, more broadly, everything else.

Select Science when the claim is pertinent to the scientific field but not about medical or climate matters.

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